Incident Slack Transcript

Bez 15:11:40.051Z
Today is the '50% off sale' That's only limited for today and will go live in 45 minutes, so we are expecting huge amount in customer sales and users.

Tinus 15:11:43.980Z
For those not aware we had decrease in sales as of last couple weeks but hopefully this sale can make up for it.

Bez 15:11:48.874Z
We need to be on top of any issues that come our way but i got high hopes that nothing should happen

Daniel 15:11:52.892Z
Your just gonna jinx us Bez.

U03CD3S4A0J 15:11:57.846Z
Start lvl

Bez 15:13:10.112Z
I need to be optimistic @Daniel, i dont think i can cope with another bad week.

Tanya 15:13:14.085Z
Sounds like you could use a vacation Bez

Bez 15:13:20.068Z
I wished i had the time <@U047N6LUYJX>

Bob 15:13:22.205Z
Sorry to interupt everyone but reports are flooding in. Platform seems to be down. I've never seen anything like this

Bob 15:13:28.113Z
Customers are completely outraged. Im seeing mostly posts like these on "X"

Sarah 15:13:32.219Z
Bob give me the exact user impact

Bob 15:13:32.341Z

Bob 15:13:37.204Z
Looks like some customers think the sale is live now

Bez 15:13:42.142Z
Damn it, I'll be in the business coms keep me updated on this @Sarah Butt

Shay 15:13:47.126Z
I'll try the website and re-create whatever the issue is

Bob 15:13:50.132Z
Sorry everyone i might not be too reponsive getting overwhelmed here with these reports

Bob 15:13:50.871Z
I will gather some reports

Bob 15:13:56.159Z
I'll be back from time to time to answer any questions, good luck everyone

Shay 15:14:02.202Z
Just checked the website and it's down for me, anyone else?

Sarah 15:14:06.842Z
Shay who is the most experienced developer when can bring in

Sarah 15:14:14.574Z
Also Tanya who can you bring in

Daniel 15:14:20.374Z
That would be me

Shay 15:14:27.868Z
@Daniel and tanya

Sarah 15:14:33.331Z
Hey Daniel can you tell me what you are seeing so far?

Sarah 15:14:41.568Z
Bob is need a clear statement of what business impact is

Bob 15:14:45.572Z
from what i can tell most of the reports seems to be coming from these regions

Bob 15:14:48.484Z
I got some of my team to gather the customer reports as of the last 15 minutes

Bob 15:14:56.046Z

Tinus 15:14:58.717Z
Can someone explain to me what is going on?

Daniel 15:14:59.913Z
Let me check logs and see what is the situation with services

Bob 15:15:00.693Z
It's not looking good. It seems to be that the majority of our European customers are getting this issue

Shay 15:15:27.506Z
This looks like a mainly europe

Sarah 15:15:46.057Z
Daniel what are you seeing? Do we have anything in how we network or load balance or anything that would just affect europe?

Daniel 15:16:04.080Z
I can see a few errors in currency service
ERROR: [Cart] Failed to retrieve cart data. Service unavailable.
and a few more ERROR: [Currency] Connection reset by peer during currency update.
ERROR: [Payments] Transaction processing took longer than 5 seconds.
That is a lot of of services being impacted

Alex 15:16:27.232Z
<@U047N6LHU0K> <@U047N90R8KU> We're aware of an issue affecting primarily EMEA. We have confirmation of order confirmations and user activity dropping around 10:13am. We're currently starting an investigation.

Sarah 15:16:27.380Z
Ok, Daniel, Tanya what would be widespread like that? Any changes? Do we see any load issues?

Tanya 15:16:40.646Z
Let me check changes

Shay 15:16:49.103Z
There were a few deployments, here is the list of them
https://uptime-labs.atlassian.net/wiki/spaces/ULPUBLIC/pages/450953217/Breaking+Bez+Change+Request+Logs

Tanya 15:17:13.103Z
behaviour is odd , it seems like services are restarting

Sarah 15:17:17.296Z
Shay anything look interesting on that channel?

Sarah 15:17:30.325Z
Sorry Shay anything look interesting on that deployment change list?

Tanya 15:17:34.787Z
what would cause services randomly restart!!

Sarah 15:17:40.714Z
Tanya, what services are restarting?

Daniel 15:17:46.981Z
Regarding load balancing, nothing that i can think of

Sarah 15:17:50.055Z
And what underlying infrastructure do they sit on

Daniel 15:18:04.776Z
It looks like all services are restarting

Sarah 15:18:24.188Z
Daniel tell me what the current time is

Shay 15:18:31.657Z
currency change is worth checking out

Daniel 15:18:56.253Z
Btw, do we have ticket for this?

Tanya 15:18:58.431Z
Sarah so far I can see FrontEnd restarting, CurrencyServices,

Shay 15:19:03.641Z
I can have a look at it

Sarah 15:19:03.861Z
Ok who is best to look at the currency change? Daniel?

Tanya 15:19:04.425Z
to be fair all of them

Tanya 15:19:16.975Z
strangely they go down together

Sarah 15:19:23.871Z
Daniel and Shay look at that currency change. When did it go in and can we roll it back

Shay 15:19:27.110Z
ok

Daniel 15:19:31.590Z
understood, i will have a look

Sarah 15:19:36.876Z
How soon can you get me an answer?

Daniel 15:19:55.547Z
it went live 27h hour

Daniel 15:20:15.954Z
*27h ago

Sarah 15:20:26.717Z
Shay why does that look suspicious to you?

Tanya 15:20:35.673Z
I don't think it is change related

Sarah 15:20:38.553Z
I need someone not look at change

Shay 15:20:39.569Z
i saw errors in logs mentioning currency service

Tanya 15:20:44.921Z
the services are restarting

Sarah 15:20:53.178Z
Ok Shay keep looking at that on the side I want to pivot the main bridge

Tanya 15:20:54.114Z
one change can't affect all of the services

Sarah 15:21:05.209Z

Tanya what can you tell me about these restarts. Do we have logs?

Daniel 15:21:12.543Z
I have reviewed the change, It looks healthy. No issues found with deployment

Sarah 15:21:33.511Z
Daniel can you look at the health of the infra? Are we running out of hardware resources or something else?

Shay 15:21:46.833Z
Website is now working again

Bob 15:21:48.875Z
It's working for me as well, great. I'll let the customers know the platform is back up

Daniel 15:21:51.905Z
Strange the apps seems to be working again, it's like the system was restarted but not on our end

Tinus 15:22:00.891Z
Ah! I just noticed an email from DC provider. there is a service notice

Tinus 15:22:11.611Z
could this be related?

Sarah 15:22:20.633Z
Tinus tell me all you can about that

Sarah 15:22:26.242Z
Can you copy the text here?

Tinus 15:22:27.941Z
email was in my junk box

Tinus 15:22:53.010Z
Should we raise a ticket?

Sarah 15:22:57.522Z
Tinus I need the text of that email

Sarah 15:23:02.259Z
What exactly did they tell us

Sarah 15:23:07.366Z

Did they have an issue?

Shay 15:23:18.853Z
Platform is down again

Bob 15:23:23.901Z
Oh no, i messed up. I just was after letting customers know the platform seems to be working for now

Shay 15:23:27.291Z
So this is not application-related issue?

Bob 15:23:28.958Z
The reports are flooding in again

Tinus 15:23:32.663Z
Apparently they are aware AC system in the DC.

Bob 15:23:34.959Z
@Sarah Butt i'll await for your confirmation this time. Ill also direct message Bez and let him know

Tanya 15:23:41.494Z
shall I raise a support call with DC?

Sarah 15:23:50.470Z
Tanya get the DC folks on the phone with us

Bez 15:23:53.059Z
Bob you got to be bettter than this, how could you be so careless to let the customers know so early?

Tanya 15:23:54.611Z
on it!

Sarah 15:23:54.984Z
Highest priority ticket possible

Bob 15:23:58.925Z
Sorry Bez i just rushed as soon as I seen the platform was back up, wont happen again

Bez 15:24:04.039Z
Good, i can't deal with any other mistakes today

Sarah 15:24:27.270Z
Bez we will handle any concerns about this later. If you'd like to help, you can engage any escaltion contacts you have with our DC vendor

Tanya 15:24:29.211Z
@Tinus , do you have the link for DC support wiki?

Tanya 15:24:32.772Z
I can't find it

Tinus 15:24:56.902Z
I created the pages in 2020

Tinus 15:25:13.137Z
let me look for it

Alex 15:25:14.765Z
<@U047N91SRH8> do you have the ability to pull the numbers for % customers impacted?

Tanya 15:25:26.738Z
found it, raising a ticket

Tanya 15:25:48.718Z
ok, Response SLA is 4 hours

Sarah 15:25:52.853Z
<@U047N90R8KU> are you in a spot to reach out to your executive contacts at the DC vendor to escalate once Tanya gets that ticket in?

Tanya 15:25:54.553Z
they just emailed me back

Sarah 15:25:59.068Z
I am not waiting 4 hours

Sarah 15:26:04.004Z
Ok Tanya what did they say

Bob 15:26:06.714Z
yes, give me moment to check for you

Tinus 15:26:07.429Z
That's insane

Sarah 15:26:12.590Z
In the meantime Daniel what is our BCP

Sarah 15:26:18.023Z
Can we fail out of that DC?

Tinus 15:26:24.232Z
it can't be

Bob 15:26:34.501Z
It looks like 65% of users are being affected by this, since we are mainly a UK/EU

Daniel 15:26:50.065Z
I will send the BCP document

Sarah 15:26:53.430Z
Daniel what is our BCP option?

Sarah 15:27:01.333Z
Do we have a quick way to get out of that datacenter?

Sarah 15:27:14.455Z
Tinus tell me exactly what the DC said the issue was in the email to you

Tanya 15:27:30.808Z
ah, I see there are two contract numbers. I raised a ticket for UAT environment

Sarah 15:27:45.489Z
Tanya, open a ticket for production

Tanya 15:27:45.523Z
I 'm trying the other contract

Sarah 15:27:49.790Z
Thank you

Tanya 15:28:05.343Z
Just got in contact with my contact who works at the data centre

Tanya 15:28:10.221Z
Apparently there's a issue with the AC unit's which is causing the servers in that data centres to overheat and shut down.

Tanya 15:28:12.449Z

She has been told it should be an easy fix and they're restarting the servers while addressing the AC units

Daniel 15:28:17.912Z
This is the document
https://uptime-labs.atlassian.net/wiki/spaces/ULPUBLIC/pages/573210626/Retail+Business+Continuity+Plan+BCP+Data+Center+Flip+IT

Shay 15:28:18.490Z
Dont mean to be interupt this conversation but how does the data centre affect us?

Hamed 15:28:23.375Z
The data centre is where physical servers are hosted, it provides CPU and memory to our k8s clusters.

Hamed 15:28:31.250Z
If the server at the data center goes down, the node in our infrastructure will stop running causing microservices like the frontend, payments etc to stop functioning

Tanya 15:28:37.349Z
I think we are ok now as my contact has just told me that they have successfully restarted the server.

Daniel 15:28:42.277Z
Your right, i can also see that the website is back up and running again

Shay 15:28:44.352Z
What do you think @Sarah Butt do we just wait until the AC units are fixed?

Sarah 15:28:53.556Z
I worry that isn't going to keep us stable for long

Sarah 15:29:02.954Z
Someone tell me about the BCP. How soon could we move over and how much risk?

Shay 15:29:03.382Z
The server must be down again because the platform isn't working for me anymore

Tanya 15:29:07.374Z
Im going to be honest and say we wait for the ac unit to be fixed

Tanya 15:29:12.330Z
I reckon they shouldn't take much longer to address the ac issue

Tanya 15:29:12.842Z
I heard back - it's definitely AC issue, the room is heating up causing servers to restart. They gave me an ETA of 15 mins

Tanya 15:29:16.074Z
to fix AC

Hamed 15:29:21.342Z
@Tanya @Sarah Butt we could swap traffic to another data centre

Tanya 15:29:27.343Z
No Hamed, that is a huge risk which could take even longer than needed

Sarah 15:29:33.097Z
How much risk and time is involved in that?

Hamed 15:29:33.328Z
@Sarah Butt every Quarter we plan scheduled data centre migrations mainly for disaster recovery purposes

Hamed 15:29:38.296Z
We could move traffic to another Data centre in N.America

Tanya 15:29:45.363Z
It could take too long Hamed a previous RTO in Q2 took over 2 hours

Tanya 15:29:50.649Z
Hamed 15:29:56.439Z
Your right Tanya but in Q3 the migration only took 50 minutes, still not great but better than 2 hours

Tanya 15:30:01.827Z
Yes but anything could easily go wrong and make things worse for our customer base using the N.America servers

Tanya 15:30:06.516Z
The safer option would be to wait for the ac units to be fixed

Hamed 15:30:11.508Z
We could wait or we can take action now, it hasn't been confirmed that the ac units will even get fixed soon

Alex 15:30:13.266Z
Conditions:

• There is a website issue impacting primarily the EMEA region starting around 10:13am
• It's an issue with our datacenter and we have a case open with the provider
• Evaluating our BCP plans to look into failing out of the impacted datacenter
Actions:
• A ticket has been opened with our provider
• The social media team is working on comms
Needs
• ETA from our datacenter provider
• Look for failover plans in the BCP

Tanya 15:30:16.478Z
The ac units could take less time than a data centre flip Hamed. But its not our call @Sarah Butt. Its your decision.

Hamed 15:30:19.392Z
@Sarah Minimum risk

Tanya 15:30:41.047Z
It has been inconsistent, even last failover we did was soft exercise, under control over planne ddowntime

Tanya 15:30:52.289Z
in reality we have not done so during core business hours

Tinus 15:31:50.821Z
Should we not wait for DC?

Sarah 15:32:08.149Z
Questions
1- can we move part of the traffic? Or is it all or nothing? - Tanya, Hamed answer
2- are there servers in the area of the DC we can shut down? Is our UAT there and able to be shut down for instance? - Tanya, Daniel anwer
3- Can the DC vendor give us an ETA? Is there anything else they can do to cool the room they are not already doing? Are we the only tenant there - Tinus answer

Tanya 15:32:33.433Z
I heard back from DC, they extend for another 10 minutes.

Hamed 15:32:40.022Z
We have to move all traffic

Tanya 15:33:25.211Z
answer to question 2 - UAT is not affected. it's located to another location

Daniel 15:33:35.331Z
As for 2nd question, sadly we can't shut it down partially

Alex 15:33:53.501Z
Failover steps from DC1 to DC2
1. Notify stakeholders (IT teams, store managers, customers).
2. Stop non-critical services in DC1
3. Sync critical retail data between DC1 and DC2
4. Reconfigure IP address in DNS console to point traffic to DC2.
5. Activate application systems (e-commerce and payment) in DC2
6. Validate systems (transactions, orders, performance).

Tinus 15:33:58.092Z
Sarah , why we leave our faith on third party's hand

Tinus 15:34:01.836Z
we are dead in the water

Sarah 15:34:10.444Z
Tinus I will deal with anything like that after the incident thanks

Sarah 15:34:51.035Z
Daniel, would you fail over or stay? What is your advice?

Tanya 15:35:01.820Z
I had another update from DC - they need little bit more time

Tanya 15:35:09.903Z
next update from them in 10 mins

Sarah 15:35:16.653Z
Ok we are going to line up a failover

Shay 15:35:26.603Z
please guid us through

Sarah 15:35:41.492Z
Who is best to do step 1, Notify stakeholders (IT teams, store managers, customers).

Bob 15:35:45.862Z
I will take care of that

Bob 15:35:54.135Z
I will let everyone know!

Sarah 15:35:54.584Z
Thanks Bob. How soon can you have that done?

Bob 15:35:58.006Z
consider it done!

Sarah 15:36:12.292Z
Ok who is best to do step 2 Stop non-critical services in DC1

Daniel 15:36:15.914Z
Leave it to me

Daniel 15:36:22.306Z
I will start right away

Sarah 15:36:26.480Z
Ok Daniel please go ahead. How long will it take?

Daniel 15:36:32.424Z
give me a few mins

Sarah 15:36:40.305Z
Define a few. 5? Less?

Daniel 15:36:46.230Z
2 mins

Sarah 15:37:09.180Z
Thanks

Daniel 15:37:31.051Z
I have stopped all noncritical services

Sarah 15:37:34.946Z
I want to go ahead and line up but not action steps
3. Sync critical retail data between DC1 and DC2
4. Reconfigure IP address in DNS console to point traffic to DC2.
Who is on deck to do each of those those? Can we do any prework?

Hamed 15:38:16.351Z
I will start syncing data, it's mostly synced

Sarah 15:38:25.364Z

Thanks Hamed. Can you give me an ETA?

Tanya 15:38:44.761Z
I'm ready to to do DNS changes. waiting for your go-head Tanya

Hamed 15:38:53.881Z
give me 2 mins to ensure all data is sunced

Sarah 15:38:58.954Z
Thank Tanya please hold

Sarah 15:39:46.000Z
Want to do a bit of prework, who will be responsible for Activate application systems (e-commerce and payment) in DC2 which is step 5? And is there any prework we can do?

Hamed 15:39:49.888Z
Alright, we are good to go

Tanya 15:40:13.885Z
Am I good to go ahead?

Sarah 15:40:16.258Z
Ok Tanya go

Tanya 15:40:22.177Z
started

Sarah 15:40:22.768Z
who will be responsible for Activate application systems (e-commerce and payment) in DC2 which is step 5? And is there any prework we can do?

Sarah 15:40:29.347Z
Also Tanya what is the ETA on DNS?

Tanya 15:40:53.753Z
bad news! got an error in the script

Sarah 15:41:02.003Z
Ok what is the error

Tinus 15:41:08.949Z
that's it, happened last time too

Tinus 15:41:13.414Z

was it not fixed

Sarah 15:41:25.551Z
How did we get around it last time

Sarah 15:41:34.183Z
Let's deal with fixed later and just get around it now

Tanya 15:41:38.066Z
I need to make sure the records are not in inconsistent state.

Sarah 15:41:48.938Z
Ok do you have everyone you need for that? How long will it take?

Sarah 15:42:03.605Z
In parallel, who will be responsible for Activate application systems (e-commerce and payment) in DC2 which is step 5? And is there any prework we can do?